

Changing the Command Line's PATH Environment Variable

You can change the current terminal window's `PATH` environment variable to include additional folders. The process for adding folders to `PATH` varies slightly between Windows and macOS/Linux. On Windows, you can run the `path` command to add a new folder to the current `PATH` value:

```
❶ C:\Users\Al>path C:\newFolder;%PATH%

❷ C:\Users\Al>path
C:\newFolder;C:\Path;C:\WINDOWS\system32;C:\WINDOWS;C:\WINDOWS\System32\Wbem;
--snip--
C:\Users\Al\AppData\Local\Microsoft\WindowsApps
```

The `%PATH%` part ❶ expands to the current value of the `PATH` environment variable, so you're adding the new folder and a semicolon to the beginning of the existing `PATH` value. You can run the `path` command again to see the new value of `PATH` ❷.

On macOS and Linux, you can set the `PATH` environment variable with syntax similar to an assignment statement in Python:

```
❶ al@al-VirtualBox:~$ PATH=/newFolder:$PATH
❷ al@al-VirtualBox:~$ echo $PATH
/newFolder:/home/al/.local/bin:/usr/local/sbin:/usr/local/bin:/usr/sbin:/usr/bin:
/sbin:/bin:/usr/games:/usr/local/games:/snap/bin
```

The `$PATH` part ❶ expands to the current value of the `PATH` environment variable, so you're adding the new folder and a colon to the existing `PATH` value. You can run the `echo $PATH` command again to see the new value of `PATH` ❷.

But the previous two methods for adding folders to `PATH` apply only to the current terminal window and any programs run from it after the addition. If you open a new terminal window, it won't have your changes. Permanently adding folders requires changing the operating system's set of environment variables.

Permanently Adding Folders to PATH on Windows